



Figure 1: Wallpaper Types under Desktop Settings

an interactive globe as your desktop background.

Another pleasant surprise is that now you can have different activities for different workspaces. If you are the type who uses a lot of widgets, and finds it difficult to fit all of these into one screen, in earlier versions you probably needed to switch between activities to set some other widgets that wouldn't fit into your primary activity. However, let's face it, switching between activities is not the easiest of jobs. With version 4.3, you can configure each workspace as a separate activity and thus have different widgets, wallpapers, etc. on different workspaces (see Figure 3)—and thankfully, switching between workspaces is much easier.

However, the best feature among the 50-odd widgets that come with KDE 4.3, is the new enhancement added to the Folder View widget, which prompted me to switch to my home directory as my default location from the `~/Desktop` folder I have been using for a year. Now, hovering over a folder in Folder View lets me peek into the folder's contents, thanks to an overlay effect (Figure 2). With this sort of feature now available, you don't have to launch Dolphin to locate or access your files—just navigate the filesystem and access files straight from your desktop with a single (double) click.

To think about it, I must mention the inclusion of two widgets, the first of which is openDesktop. If you set the latitude and longitude on which you are located, this widget has the ability to show you other users



Figure 2: Peeking into the Folder View



Figure 3: Different activities for different workspaces

who are nearby. However, for this to work, you need an account with opendesktop.org; besides, there's not much you can do with the widget. It definitely shows some promise, and I won't be surprised if it becomes a major contestant soon among the various social networking tools.

The second widget seems handy for those who like to plan their days with different tasks, et al. It's called Remember the Milk, and its purpose is to keep you in sync with the RTM online service. Again, you need an online account to be able to use it. Besides these two, the Microblogging widget now has Identi.ca support, apart from Twitter.

The system notifications have

acquired some polish. Building on top of the notification system that was introduced in version 4.2, it now has a dedicated icon on the system tray. Running tasks now slide into this notification icon and are grouped together, not taking up too much of screen space. An animating icon signifies that jobs are still running. However, the 'More' and 'Less' buttons for notifications (for example, in the copy dialog), still need a lot of attention.

Coming to the various application enhancements, KRunner continues to improve. It now displays the search results as a list instead of as icons—the layout now gives it more room to display